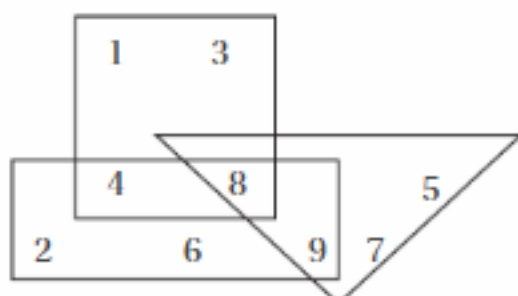


# 8. The Farmer Who Bought a Well



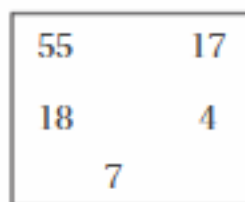
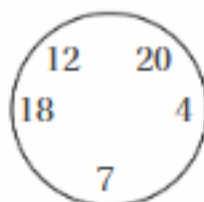
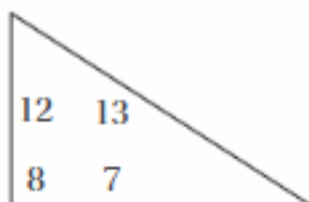
## Warm-up

Work in pairs to play this fun game! Read the hints carefully and look at the diagrams to find out the secret numbers.



1. Hints:
  - a. The number is in the rectangle.
  - b. The number is in the square and the triangle.
  - c. The number is greater than 5.

The number is .....



2. Hints:
  - a. The number is in the square.
  - b. The number is in the circle.
  - c. The number is two times 9.

The number is .....



Birbal was a minister in the great Mughal emperor Akbar's court. He was known in Akbar's court for his **wit** and **presence of mind**. The folklores of Akbar and Birbal are quite famous in India.



A poor farmer lived in a village which was far from the river. There was not even a small stream or pond near his village. He was always worried about how he would water his crop, so that he could get a rich **harvest** from his fields. Finally, he decided that he would buy a well and use the water for his crop.



The farmer went to the richest man, a merchant who lived in his village. This rich merchant owned three wells. The merchant agreed to sell and fixed a price for one of his wells. The farmer bought a well from the rich merchant so that he could water his land using the water from the well. The farmer was very happy after buying the well. He thought his troubles had come to an end. Alas! His happiness was very short-lived.

The next day, when the farmer went to **draw** water from the well, the rich man stopped him and did not allow him to take any water. The rich merchant was a **wily** old man. He played a trick on the simple farmer. He said that the farmer had bought only the well and not the water in the well. So, he could not allow the farmer to take any water. The farmer had to pay more money for the water.

**wit**

*intelligence*

**presence of mind**

*the ability to find solutions to problems instantly*

**harvest**

*crop that is cut and collected*

**draw (here)**

*take out*

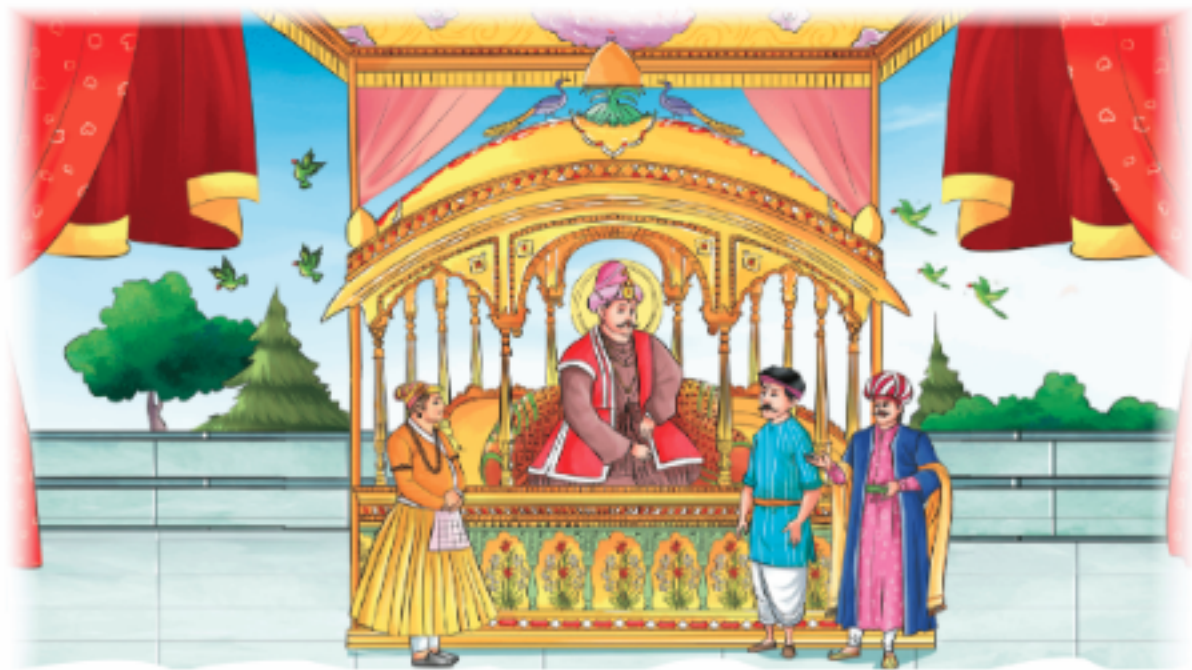
**wily**

*cunning*

Not knowing what to do, the farmer went to the Mughal emperor

Akbar's court and requested an **audience**. Emperor Akbar listened to the farmer's complaint carefully and handed over the case to Birbal.

Birbal was the Emperor's adviser and minister. The Emperor had great faith in Birbal's judgement.



Birbal visited the rich merchant who was troubling the poor farmer. The rich man repeated what he had told the farmer. Hearing this Birbal said, "Since you have sold the well and not the water to the farmer, you **will** have to move all the water from the well or pay rent to the farmer to keep your water in his well."

The rich man realised how he was in a trap and his greedy plan was not going to work. He apologised for trying to cheat the poor farmer and said that the farmer had every right to use the well and also the water.

**audience**

*(here) a formal meeting with the Emperor*



## Reading

(reading for main ideas)

**A. Choose the right options to answer these questions. Work in pairs.**

**Share your answers with your partner. Check each other's answers.**



1. The farmer was always worried because
  - a. all the rivers near his field had dried up.
  - b. all the rivers and ponds were polluted.
  - c. he could not find water for his crop.
  - d. he had no money to buy a well.
2. What did the rich merchant do when the farmer went to him?
  - a. He fixed a price and sold a well to the farmer.
  - b. He fixed a price and sold all three of his wells to the farmer.
  - c. He refused to sell a well and demanded more money.
  - d. He asked the farmer to dig a well for himself.
3. Birbal asked the rich man to
  - a. apologise to the farmer.
  - b. meet Emperor Akbar at his court.
  - c. pay rent to the farmer for keeping water in his well.
  - d. give away all three of his wells for free.



**B. Answer these questions. Revise the chapter before checking your answers.**



1. Why was the farmer worried and what did he decide to do?
2. What trick did the rich merchant play on the farmer?
3. Where did the farmer go for help?



**C. Think and answer.**



**(reading for inference; HOTS)**

1. Could the Emperor have solved the farmer's problem himself? Why was Birbal called for help?
2. Why did the merchant decide to trick the farmer when he went to draw water from the well and not when the farmer bought the well?

**D. Discuss in class.**



**(value-based question)**

What lesson did the merchant learn by trying to trick the farmer?



## Using Grammar

**(using negative forms)**

Read these sentences.

- The farmer looks forward to a good harvest.
- The farmer does not look forward to a good harvest.

The first sentence is an affirmative one, that is, it is a statement that says yes. The second is a negative one and implies no.

- 1 A. Change these sentences from affirmative to negative. Show your answers to your teacher and discuss the answers. What other changes did you make while writing the negative sentences? Understand the changes with the help of your teacher.**



1. I like waking up early in the morning.
2. We have a sports period every day.
3. Ravi wants to study with Hitesh.
4. Our class won the prize.
5. I travel to school by bus.



**(framing wh- questions)**

**Wh-** questions begin with **what, when, where, who, whom, which, whose, why** and **how**. We use them to ask for information. The answers cannot be 'yes' or 'no'.

Read this sentence.

The rich merchant owns three wells.

Now, let us convert it into a **wh-** question.

What does the rich merchant own?

**B. Work in pairs and convert these sentences into **wh-** questions.**



1. Orchids are usually found in humid tropical forests.
2. A hummingbird's egg is tinier than a jelly bean.
3. A female kangaroo carries its joey in its pouch.
4. Squirrels hibernate in hollow trees during harsh winters.
5. Our class teacher and principal took us to the National Science Museum.



**(interjections)**

Read this sentence.

"Wow!" said Father owl joyfully when the young owl flew for the first time.

**Wow** is an **interjection**. We use interjections to show our happiness, surprise, sadness, anger or other feelings.

An interjection is usually followed by an exclamation mark (!).



**C. Fill in the blanks with the right interjections from the box. Then write the suitable interjections under the pictures.**



Help

Ugh

Wow

How pretty

1. \_\_\_\_\_! I've never seen such a beautiful bird.
2. \_\_\_\_\_! It's the biggest ice cream in the world.
3. \_\_\_\_\_! My foot's stuck in the grating.
4. \_\_\_\_\_! That's a really ugly painting.

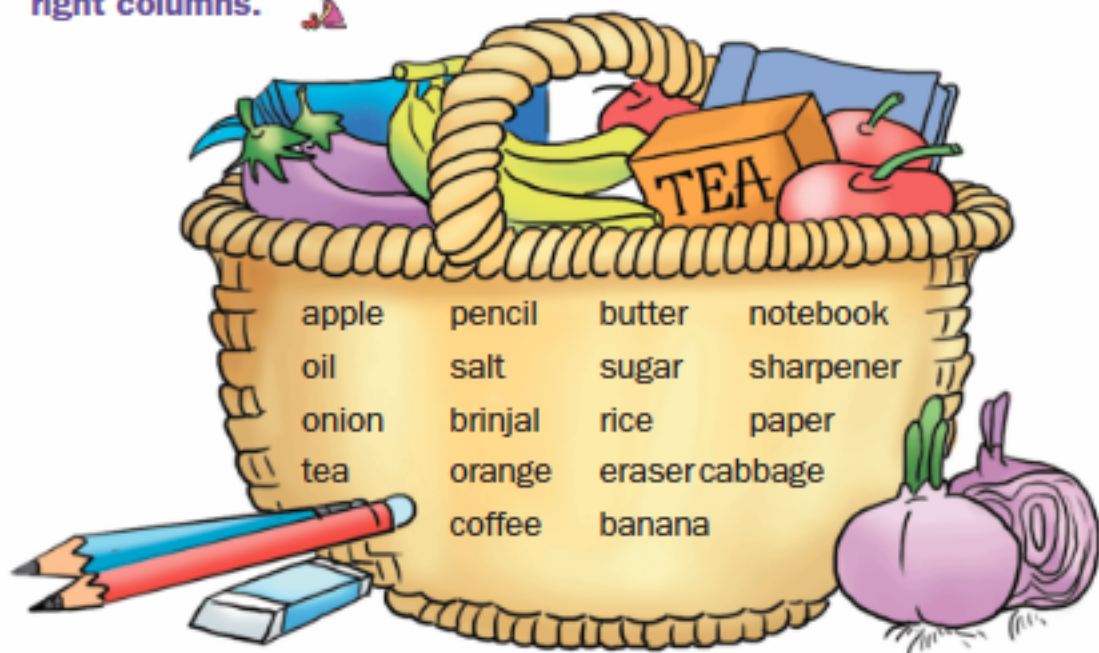




## Using Words

(word families)

A. The shopping basket is full of all kinds of things. Arrange them in the right columns. 



| Fruits | Grocery | Stationery | Vegetables |
|--------|---------|------------|------------|
|        |         |            |            |

Read this sentence.

(phrasal verbs)

The forest guard showed us how to get at bee hives located on high branches.

The expression **get at** is a phrasal verb. A **phrasal verb** is formed by using a verb with a preposition or an adverb.

B. Here are some more expressions with **get**. Use them to complete the sentences on the next page. 

- get along: be friendly with
- get away: escape
- get out: leave
- get back: return to a place



1. Give me a call when you **get** \_\_\_\_\_.
2. The film star tried to **get** \_\_\_\_\_ from the crowd.
3. I'll **get** \_\_\_\_\_ of the car when you stop at the traffic lights.
4. We **get** \_\_\_\_\_ well with everybody.



## Assessment of Speaking and Listening



### Listening

(listening for the main ideas)

Listen to the passage and answer these questions. Check your answers.



1. What is a Venus flytrap?
2. What does the plant depend on for its nutrition?
3. Where is the Venus flytrap found?
4. How do the leaves trap insects?
5. How long does it take to digest an insect?

### Pronunciation

(diphthong in ear)

A. Say these words aloud. Notice that the letters in **bold** in these words have the same sound.

ear clear nearly

B. What are diphthongs? Take the help of your teacher to know about some common diphthongs used in English language.



### Speaking

(speaking on a topic)

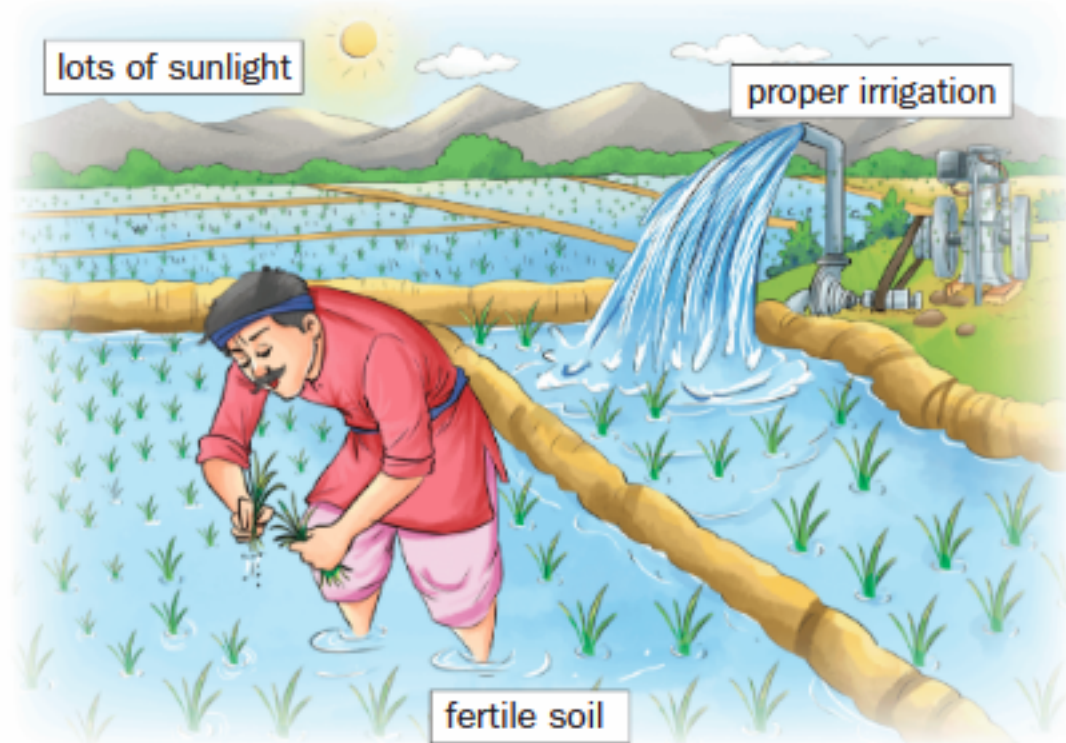
Work in pairs. Imagine you are a farmer with a piece of land and you want to grow your own crop. What factors will impact your choice of crop?



You may think about these points.

- Which geographical area do you live in?
- What are the climatic conditions of your region?
- What type of soil does the crop need?
- Which is the harvest season for your crop?

**Take help of the picture given here. Discuss your answer.**



## Writing

**(explaining a process)**

Read this paragraph.

First, the farmer bought a well from the rich merchant. Next, he tried to draw water from his well. Then, the rich man tricked him. Finally, the farmer went to the Emperor for justice.

This paragraph shows the order in which certain things happen.

Look at this process describing how to make a sandwich.



1

First, spread some butter evenly on a slice of bread.



2

Next, place some cut tomatoes and onions on the slice.



3

Then, add some grated cheese on top.



4

Finally, cover the slice with another slice of bread.

Your sandwich is ready.

Write the process describing how you pack your school lunch. Make notes in this flowchart and then write it as a paragraph. Describe the process to your partner and ask him/her to do the same.



First,

Next,

Then,

Finally,



## Life Skills Activity

(critical thinking)

Do you know the difference between **fact** and **opinion**? A **fact** is something that can be proven to be true. It is often based on research and data. An **opinion** is someone's feeling about a particular subject. An opinion is always based on personal preference and experience.

**Here are some statements. Discuss them in groups. Decide whether these statements are facts or opinions.**  **CT** **TC**

1. Pesticide, if used in large quantities, can damage our environment.
2. Autumn is the most beautiful season of all.
3. Swimming is the best form of exercise.
4. A block of iron sinks in water but a ball does not.
5. It is better to grow one's own vegetables than buy them from the market.
6. Tomatoes are fruits and brinjals are vegetables.
7. Jupiter is the largest planet in our Solar System.
8. Cotton clothes are the best.

